

D621

Social and Behavioral Determinants of Health

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A family living in a duplex with a large vegetable garden often skips blood pressure medication refills so they can pay rent. Their pharmacy is two blocks away. Which social determinant domain is the main barrier?

- A. Health care access and quality.
- B. Economic stability.
- C. Neighborhood and built environment.
- D. Social and community context.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

A state survey, which won an award for its sampling design, reports life expectancy by income group from lowest to highest: 74, 77, 79, 81, and 83 years. Which statement best describes the pattern?

- A. Only the lowest group has worse health.
- B. Health improves at every step up the income ladder.
- C. Life expectancy falls as income rises.
- D. Income fully determines life expectancy.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

Children in an apartment complex, built in 1962 and recently sold to a new owner, have high rates of asthma ER visits. Inspectors found mold and pests in many units. Which action is most upstream?

- A. Give each child a new inhaler.
- B. Add a pediatric asthma nurse to the ER.
- C. Enforce housing codes so mold and pests are fixed.
- D. Wait to see whether the new owner makes repairs.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which response to type 2 diabetes in a low-income neighborhood is the most downstream?

- A.** Adding sidewalks and parks.
- B.** Dialysis for patients with kidney failure.
- C.** Raising the minimum wage.
- D.** Zoning to bring a grocery store to the area.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A 30-year-old office worker, who runs marathons and just changed jobs, says she skips the flu shot because she's healthy and unlikely to catch the flu. Which Health Belief Model construct explains her choice?

- A.** Lack of cues to action from her new employer.
- B.** Low perceived severity.
- C.** High perceived barriers.
- D.** Low perceived susceptibility.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A clinic sends a text: "Your flu shot is due. Walk-ins welcome today." Which Health Belief Model construct is this?

- A.** Cue to action.
- B.** Perceived susceptibility.
- C.** Perceived benefits.
- D.** Self-efficacy.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A smoker who has tried quitting twice before tells a counselor, "I'm quitting on the first of next month. I've bought patches and told my family." He smokes a pack a day. Which stage is he in?

- A.** Preparation.
- B.** Relapse, because he has tried before.
- C.** Contemplation.
- D.** Action.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A woman quit smoking eight months ago and has not smoked since. Which stage is she in?

- A.** Termination is guaranteed after six months.
- B.** Action.
- C.** Preparation.
- D.** Maintenance.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

In a diabetes program held at a community center with free parking, participants cook simple healthy meals in a teaching kitchen, starting with easy recipes and building up. By week six, most say they feel sure they can cook this way at home. Which construct is the program building?

- A.** Self-efficacy.
- B.** Perceived severity.
- C.** Knowledge alone.
- D.** Outcome expectations.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A city council, after a heated three-hour meeting, passes an ordinance requiring calorie labels on chain restaurant menus. At which level of the social ecological model does this act?

- A.** Interpersonal.
- B.** Individual.
- C.** Public policy.
- D.** Organizational.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A program wants to act at the interpersonal level of the social ecological model. Which activity fits?

- A.** A pamphlet for each person.
- B.** A state tax on sugary drinks.
- C.** Pairing new walkers with a buddy from their block.
- D.** A company offering on-site fitness classes.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A college campaign, launched during a busy midterm week, tells students that most of their friends approve of getting tested for STIs. Which Theory of Planned Behavior construct is it targeting?

- A.** Perceived barriers from busy schedules.
- B.** Perceived behavioral control.
- C.** Attitude toward the behavior.
- D.** Subjective norms.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	____	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer B Concept 1

A family living in a duplex ~~with a large vegetable garden~~ often skips blood pressure medication refills so they can pay rent. ~~Their pharmacy is two blocks away.~~ Which social determinant domain is the main barrier?

Target word: domain **Decides:** Choosing rent over medicine is a money constraint.

A	Adjacent category	Care is nearby; the cost tradeoff is economic.
B	Correct	The barrier is income and cost.
C	Camouflage	The garden and nearby pharmacy are not the barrier.
D	Confusion set	No social isolation or discrimination is described.

2. Answer B Concept 2

A state survey, ~~which won an award for its sampling design,~~ reports life expectancy by income group from lowest to highest: 74, 77, 79, 81, and 83 years. Which statement best describes the pattern?

Target word: interpret the pattern **Decides:** Each step up is healthier.

A	Dropped element	Middle groups also trail those above them.
B	Correct	A graded pattern across all levels.
C	Inverted operation	The numbers rise with income.
D	Absolute language	Income is linked, not the sole cause.

3. Answer C Concept 3

Children in an apartment complex, ~~built in 1962 and recently sold to a new owner,~~ have high rates of asthma ER visits. Inspectors found mold and pests in many units. Which action is most upstream?

Target word: most upstream **Decides:** Fixing housing conditions removes the cause.

A	Inverted operation	Downstream treatment.
B	Adjacent category	Better care, still downstream.
C	Correct	Changes the conditions that cause attacks.
D	Camouflage	The ownership change does not act on the cause.

4. Answer B Concept 3 · transfer

Which response to type 2 diabetes in a low-income neighborhood is the most downstream?

Target word: most downstream **Decides:** Treating established disease.

A	Confusion set	Upstream built-environment change.
B	Correct	Treats advanced disease.
C	Adjacent category	Upstream economic change.
D	Inverted operation	Upstream.

5. Answer D Concept 4

A 30-year-old office worker, who runs marathons ~~and just changed jobs~~, says she skips the flu shot because she's healthy and unlikely to catch the flu. Which Health Belief Model construct explains her choice?

Target word: HBM construct **Decides:** She thinks she is unlikely to get it.

A	Camouflage	The job change is not her stated reason.
B	Confusion set	Severity is how bad it would be, not how likely.
C	Adjacent category	She names no cost or access obstacle.
D	Correct	She doubts the flu can happen to her.

6. Answer A Concept 4 • transfer

A clinic sends a text: "Your flu shot is due. Walk-ins welcome today." Which Health Belief Model construct is this?

Target word: name the construct from the intervention **Decides:** A prompt to act.

A	Correct	A trigger that prompts behavior.
B	Confusion set	It says nothing about risk.
C	Adjacent category	No benefit is described.
D	Inverted operation	It does not build confidence to perform the behavior.

7. Answer A Concept 5

A smoker ~~who has tried quitting twice before~~ tells a counselor, "I'm quitting on the first of next month. I've bought patches and told my family." ~~He smokes a pack a day.~~ Which stage is he in?

Target word: stage of change **Decides:** Within 30 days, with steps taken.

A	Correct	Intends to act within a month and has taken steps.
B	Camouflage	Past attempts do not define the current stage.
C	Adjacent category	Contemplation lacks a near-term plan and steps.
D	Inverted operation	He has not quit yet.

8. Answer D Concept 5 • transfer

A woman quit smoking eight months ago and has not smoked since. Which stage is she in?

Target word: stage from time since change **Decides:** Six months or more.

A	Absolute language	Relapse remains possible.
B	Adjacent category	Action covers the first six months.
C	Inverted operation	She has already changed.
D	Correct	Six months or more of sustained change.

9. Answer A Concept 6

In a diabetes program ~~held at a community center with free parking~~, participants cook simple healthy meals in a teaching kitchen, starting with easy recipes and building up. By week six, most say they feel sure they can cook this way at home. Which construct is the program building?

Target word: SCT construct **Decides:** Mastery experiences build confidence.

A	Correct	Mastery experiences raise confidence to perform.
B	Confusion set	A Health Belief Model construct.
C	Dropped element	Hands-on success, not facts, built confidence.
D	Adjacent category	Beliefs about results, not confidence to act.

10. Answer C Concept 7

A city council, ~~after a heated three-hour meeting~~, passes an ordinance requiring calorie labels on chain restaurant menus. At which level of the social ecological model does this act?

Target word: SEM level **Decides:** A law.

A	Confusion set	No family or peer network is targeted.
B	Inverted operation	Labels inform individuals, but the ordinance acts at policy level.
C	Correct	Laws and ordinances are the policy level.
D	Adjacent category	A restaurant's own rule would be organizational.

11. Answer C Concept 7 • transfer

A program wants to act at the interpersonal level of the social ecological model. Which activity fits?

Target word: choose the activity for the level **Decides:** Family, friends, and peers.

A	Confusion set	Individual.
B	Inverted operation	Policy level.
C	Correct	Works through relationships.
D	Adjacent category	Organizational.

12. Answer D Concept 8

A college campaign, ~~launched during a busy midterm week~~, tells students that most of their friends approve of getting tested for STIs. Which Theory of Planned Behavior construct is it targeting?

Target word: TPB construct **Decides:** What important others think.

A	Camouflage	Timing does not define the construct, and barriers belong to the HBM.
B	Confusion set	About ease or ability to act.
C	Adjacent category	Attitude is the student's own evaluation.
D	Correct	Perceived approval of others.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	2	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	11	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	8	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	2	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	8	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	5	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Five domains of social determinants	Social determinants fall into economic stability, education access and quality, health care access and quality, neighborhood and built environment, and social and community context.	Classifying by where the story happens instead of what the barrier is.	A barrier such as cost, housing, schooling, transport, or isolation.
2	The social gradient	Health improves step by step with each rise in social and economic position, not just between the poorest and everyone else.	Thinking only the poorest group has worse health.	Health outcomes reported across several income or education levels.
3	Upstream vs. downstream	Upstream actions change the social and physical conditions that cause illness; downstream actions treat people after they are sick.	Calling better treatment access an upstream fix.	A list of actions ranging from treatment to policy or housing change.
4	Health Belief Model	Action depends on perceived susceptibility, severity, benefits, barriers, cues to action, and self-efficacy.	Mixing up susceptibility (can it happen to me) with severity (how bad would it be).	A person's stated reason for acting or not acting.
5	Transtheoretical (Stages of Change) Model	Stages run precontemplation, contemplation (within 6 months), preparation (within 30 days, with steps taken), action (under 6 months), and maintenance (6 months or more).	Placing someone in action because they have a firm plan.	A time frame and whether concrete steps have been taken.
6	Social Cognitive Theory	Behavior, personal factors, and environment interact; self-efficacy grows through mastery experiences and watching similar others succeed.	Thinking information alone builds confidence.	Hands-on practice, modeling, or confidence to perform a behavior.
7	Social ecological model	Influences sit at individual, interpersonal, organizational, community, and public policy levels; strong programs act on several.	Calling a workplace rule a public policy, or a family effort individual.	Who the intervention acts on: a person, relationships, an institution, a community, or law.
8	Theory of Planned Behavior	Intention is shaped by attitude toward the behavior, subjective norms (what important others think), and perceived behavioral control.	Confusing subjective norms with personal attitude.	What friends or family approve of vs. what the person believes.

Course scope (public description): Social and Behavioral Determinants of Health provides an overview of social and behavioral determinants and their association with health behaviors, health outcomes, and health disparities. Learners examine the strategies to mitigate social determinant barriers and apply public health theories and models to elicit behavior change and to bridge the health disparity gap. There are no prerequisites for this course.